GUJARATI COLLECTION

NO. 07



GUJARAT ORIGIN

Rasawala Bateta

Potatoes in Thin Spiced Gravy

The Sunday Breakfast Companion to Puri

AUTHENTIC RECIPE · STEP-BY-STEP GUIDE · PRINTABLE DIGITAL COOKBOOK

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Rasawala Bateta

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ABOUT THIS BOOK

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DISCLAIMER

Nutrition values are estimates. Cooking times vary with equipment and ingredients. Readers with allergies or dietary restrictions should check every ingredient label before cooking.

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THE STORY BEHIND THE DISH

A Weekend Ritual in a Bowl

"Rasawala" translates roughly to "with gravy" or "juicy," and rasawala bateta lives up to its name — potatoes simmered in a thin, well-spiced tomato-based broth, distinctly more liquid than a typical dry sabzi, designed specifically to be soaked up with fried puri bread. The combination of bateta nu shaak ne puri (potato curry and puri) is a beloved Sunday breakfast ritual in many Gujarati households, a slightly more indulgent start to the day than an average weekday morning.

The dish's thin consistency is entirely intentional and central to its purpose — a thicker gravy wouldn't soak into torn pieces of puri the same way, and the ritual of tearing bread and dipping it into the spiced, tangy broth is very much part of the dish's appeal, almost as much as the flavor itself. It's comfort food built around a specific, satisfying eating experience rather than any single standout ingredient.

While closely associated with weekend mornings, rasawala bateta is simple and quick enough that many households also make it for a light dinner or an easy lunch, pairing it with rice instead of puri when a fried bread feels like too much for an ordinary weekday.

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THE STORY BEHIND THE DISH

A Weekend Ritual in a Bowl, continued

CULTURAL NOTES & OCCASIONS

Closely associated with Sunday breakfast in Gujarati households, traditionally paired with puri as "bateta nu shaak ne puri." The dish's thin, broth-like consistency is intentional, designed specifically for dipping and soaking with bread. Represents comfort food built around a specific ritual eating experience — tearing and dipping — as much as the flavor itself. Versatile enough to also serve as a quick weekday lunch or dinner, paired with rice instead of puri.

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AT A GLANCE

Equipment & preparation

10m	25m	4	Easy
ACTIVE PREP	COOK TIME	SERVINGS	DIFFICULTY

Recommended equipment

- Kadai or wide pan
- Wooden spoon

STORAGE & MAKE-AHEAD

Rasawala bateta keeps refrigerated for up to 3 days and reheats well, thinning slightly as needed with a splash of water. It freezes reasonably well for up to a month.

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WHAT YOU'LL NEED

Ingredients

For the dish

INGREDIENT	US	METRIC	INDIAN
Potatoes, cubed	4 medium	500 g	4 medium
Oil	3 tbsp	45 ml	3 chammach
Mustard seeds	1 tsp	4 g	1 chammach
Cumin seeds	1 tsp	4 g	1 chammach
Asafoetida (hing)	pinch	pinch	chutki bhar
Curry leaves	1 sprig	8–10 leaves	1 sprig
Ginger paste	1 tbsp	15 g	1 chammach
Green chili, slit	2	2	2
Tomato, pureed	2 medium	200 g	2 medium
Turmeric powder	½ tsp	1.5 g	½ chammach
Coriander powder	1 tsp	3 g	1 chammach
Red chili powder	½ tsp	1.5 g	½ chammach
Sugar	1 tsp	4 g	1 chammach
Water	3 cups	720 ml	3 katori
Salt	1 tsp	6 g	to taste
Fresh coriander, chopped, for garnish	2 tbsp	8 g	2 tbsp

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WHAT YOU'LL NEED

Ingredients, continued

SUBSTITUTIONS & SOURCING

This dish requires only common pantry staples and produce, making it very accessible for cooks anywhere in the world. Curry leaves add a distinctive aroma but can be omitted if unavailable, without dramatically changing the dish's overall character.

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STEP BY STEP · STEP-BY-STEP

Making Rasawala Bateta

01 TEMPER THE SPICES

Heat oil in a kadai and add mustard seeds, letting them pop. Add cumin seeds, asafoetida, and curry leaves, letting them sizzle.

02 ADD GINGER AND CHILI

Add the ginger paste and slit green chilies, cooking briefly until fragrant.

03 ADD TOMATO AND SPICES

Add the tomato puree, turmeric, coriander powder, and chili powder. Cook for 8–10 minutes, until the tomato thickens and the oil separates slightly at the edges.

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Making Rasawala Bateta, continued



04 ADD POTATOES AND WATER

Add the cubed potatoes, sugar, water, and salt. Bring to a boil, then reduce heat and simmer for 15–18 minutes, until the potatoes are tender and the broth has thinned to a light, pourable consistency.

Texture indicator. rasawala bateta should be noticeably thinner and more liquid than a typical potato curry, closer to a light soup than a thick sauce — this is intentional.

05 GARNISH AND SERVE

Finish with fresh coriander just before serving.

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STEP BY STEP · STEP-BY-STEP

Making Rasawala Bateta, continued



MISTAKE TO AVOID

Reducing the gravy too much, aiming for a thicker consistency, misses the point of this specific dish. Keep it thin and brothy — that's what makes it perfect for dipping puri.

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SERVING & PAIRING

How to serve



Traditional Style

- Served with puri for a classic Gujarati Sunday breakfast, torn and dipped into the thin, spiced broth.
- A beloved weekend ritual in many Gujarati households.

Family Style

- Also enjoyed with steamed rice for a lighter weekday lunch or dinner.

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SERVING & PAIRING

How to serve, continued

Modern Pairing

- Works well as a comforting, broth-forward dish alongside any simple bread.

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RESTAURANT-GRADE TRICKS

Chef secrets

Getting the Consistency Right

- Keeping the broth thin and pourable, rather than reducing it, is essential to this dish's specific purpose and appeal.
- A well-developed tomato base, cooked down properly before adding water, gives good depth despite the thin final consistency.

Make-Ahead & Meal Prep

- This dish reheats well, though you may need to add a splash of water to restore its characteristic thin consistency.
- Quick enough to make fresh most mornings if needed, without extensive advance preparation.

RESTAURANT TRICK

Some households add a small pinch of garam masala at the very end for extra warmth, though the classic version relies mainly on the base tempering spices.

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BONUS CONTENT

Nutrition, variations & FAQ

APPROXIMATE NUTRITION, PER SERVING

180 kcal	3 g	28 g	7 g	3 g
CALORIES	PROTEIN	CARBOHYDRATES	FAT	FIBER

Estimates only; actual values vary with oil and portion size.

ALLERGEN GUIDE

Contains, based on the ingredient list: Gluten, Mustard. Check packaged spices and asafoetida, which may contain wheat, and verify against your own ingredients.

REGIONAL VARIATIONS

Rasawala Bateta with Green Peas	some households add green peas for extra color and texture.
Thicker Bateta Nu Shaak	a less brothy version for those who prefer to eat it with rice rather than dipping bread.
Bateta Nu Shaak with Tomato and Onion	a version with a fuller onion-tomato base for extra richness.

Why is the gravy so thin?

This is intentional — rasawala bateta is specifically designed to be thin and brothy for dipping puri bread, unlike most other potato curries.

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BONUS CONTENT

Nutrition, variations & FAQ, continued

Can I make this thicker if I prefer?

Yes — simply reduce the water slightly and simmer a bit longer, though this changes the dish's traditional character and dipping purpose.

Is this dish very spicy?

No — it's mild and comforting, with warmth from green chili rather than significant heat.

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REFERENCE

Ingredient glossary



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REFERENCE

Ingredient glossary, continued

GLOSSARY

Rasawala	Gujarati for "with gravy" or "juicy," describing this dish's thin, brothy consistency.
Bateta	Gujarati for potato, the primary ingredient in this dish.
Puri	a small, puffed, deep-fried bread, the classic pairing for this dish.
Shaak	Gujarati for a vegetable curry or side dish.

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PRINTABLE RECIPE CARD

Rasawala Bateta

10m	25m
ACTIVE PREP	COOK TIME
4	Easy
SERVINGS	DIFFICULTY

DISH

Potatoes	500 g
Oil	45 ml
Mustard seeds	4 g
Cumin seeds	4 g
Asafoetida	pinch
Curry leaves	8–10 leaves
Ginger paste	15 g
Green chili	2
Tomato	200 g
Turmeric powder	1.5 g
Coriander powder	3 g
Red chili powder	1.5 g
Sugar	4 g
Water	720 ml
Salt	6 g
Fresh coriander	8 g

METHOD

01 **Temper the spices.** Heat oil in a kadai and add mustard seeds, letting them pop.

02 **Add ginger and chili.** Add the ginger paste and slit green chilies, cooking briefly until fragrant.

03 **Add tomato and spices.** Add the tomato puree, turmeric, coriander powder, and chili powder.

04 **Add potatoes and water.** Add the cubed potatoes, sugar, water, and salt.

05 **Garnish and serve.** Finish with fresh coriander just before serving.

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BEFORE YOU SHOP

Shopping list

☐ Potatoes	500 g	☐ Oil	45 ml
☐ Mustard seeds	4 g	☐ Cumin seeds	4 g
☐ Asafoetida	pinch	☐ Curry leaves	8–10 leaves
☐ Ginger paste	15 g	☐ Green chili	2
☐ Tomato	200 g	☐ Turmeric powder	1.5 g
☐ Coriander powder	3 g	☐ Red chili powder	1.5 g
☐ Sugar	4 g	☐ Salt	6 g
☐ Fresh coriander	8 g		

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